

Alex Gates — inform status outline (next meeting)

Date: 2026-07-16
From: Charles Levine (COMPASS-assisted skeleton — **you** add detail iteratively)
Purpose: Inform only — map the full path in minimal bullets. **Not** the decision questionnaire.
Questions / tabled items: 20260611_Alex_Gates_Talking_Points.md
Deep plan (if he asks): 03_Where_we_are_now.md · 04_Project_story_plain_English.md

1. One sentence

Cross-domain paper: **inverted-U on leave-one-out peer-pool quality** (Army → basketball → tenure preliminary) → **minimal generative mechanism** (honest claims) → **two predictions** → **Wang-style manuscript** — target **Summer–Fall 2026**.

2. Where we are (snapshot)

Leg	Status	One line
Army	✓ Anchor	CIF + Cox stack mature; AWS is canonical run environment
Basketball	✓ Replication	Inverted-U on poolq_loo ; D10 export bundle on disk
Tenure	⚠ Preliminary	Stage 9 binned plot OK for draft; 796 persons / 52 depts inference-ready
Generative model	⚠ Path II	Talent-only fails; congestion-in-score POC on pool mean (axis mismatch stated honestly)
Manuscript	☐ Next	Staging prose written; inking Word is current focus

3. The path (whole arc — briefing outline)

How to read: Top-to-bottom = time order. **Done** = already in hand. **Now** = current focus. **Parallel** = runs alongside draft; does not block first Word pass. **Before submit** = needs to land before we send the paper out. **Later** = explicitly parked unless you or Alex elevate.

Phase A — Empirical pattern across three settings (DONE)

What we proved descriptively: In each domain, advancement (promotion, draft, tenure) rises with peer-pool quality through the middle range, then dips in the most elite pools — an **inverted-U**, not “better peers always help.”

Setting	What we measured	Status
Army	Leave-one-out senior-rater pool quality vs promotion (competing risks with attrition)	Established — strongest anchor
Basketball	Leave-one-out teammate pool quality (<code>poolq_loo</code>) vs NBA draft	Established — clean replication
Tenure	Leave-one-out department peer quality vs tenure event	Preliminary — binned plot only; smaller inference sample (796 people / 52 departments)

One line for Alex: The **cross-domain stylized fact** is real in Army and basketball; tenure is an honest third panel, not a fourth anchor yet.

Phase B — Close the minimal model (NOW)

Goal: Freeze enough mechanism language that the manuscript can describe *what the model is*, *what the data columns mean*, and *what we are **not** claiming* — without waiting for a perfect simulation.

Step	Plain English	Status
B1. Score equation	Advancement score = ability minus congestion penalty (<code>S = A - λ · congestion</code>). This is the constraint-leg proof-of-concept Alex asked for — who gets selected when pools are crowded.	Locked (Tier 1)
B2. Talent-only null	Simulation with ability only (no congestion) fails to reproduce the inverted-U — congestion term is necessary for the generative story.	Done (<code>538D</code> CELL 10)
B3. Congestion proof-of-concept	Simulation with congestion bends curves on whole-roster pool average — not yet point-for-point on the same axis as empirical <code>poolq_loo</code> .	Done — axis mismatch stated honestly
B4. Axis table	Written table: each model quantity → data column → which axis the plot uses → allowed claim for version 1. Stops prose from over-claiming generative replication.	On disk (D10 export bundle)
B5. Claim guardrails	Master list: every manuscript claim tagged Supported / Preliminary / Unsupported / Defer (<code>#07</code>).	Written — VECTOR and Charles check prose against it

One line for Alex: Minimal model = **honest Path II** — generative POC on pool-mean axis + explicit limitations; **not** bin-for-bin match to empirical leave-one-out quality before draft.

Phase C — Draft the manuscript (NOW)

Structure (Wang-style): short opening frame (§0) → empirical phenomenon (§1) → theory (§2–§3) → minimal mechanism (§5) → predictions (§7). **Not** a front-loaded lit review; fuller literature map in Discussion (#12 §5.2).

Manuscript section (Word outline)	What goes there	Ink status
§0 Opening framing	Problem, gap, contribution preview, roadmap (½–1 page)	Staging §1 ready — ink on polish pass after §5→§1→§4
§1 Empirical observation	Three-setting triad + figures (Army CIF, basketball ventile, tenure preliminary)	Staging prose ready; Army figures pending AWS canon
§2–3 Theory	Why finite distinction / local comparison pools matter; L_net = B – D framing	Staging + nesting note ready
§4 Tenure setting	Preliminary third leg + limitations	Staging ready; Cell 9 plot OK for draft
§5 Minimal generative model	Talent-only fails vs congestion-in-score; axis table; limitation paragraph	Staging + D10 figures ready
§7 Predictions	Two primary prediction directions (see below)	Staging ready; one basketball figure on disk

Ink order (your current plan): write **§5** (generative) first → then **§1** (empirical triad) → then **§4** (tenure) → then **§0** (opening frame, ½–1 page polish) — so mechanism language is settled before empirical claims reference it.

Lit review (v1): §0 + §2–§3 + Discussion — **not** a separate chapter before §1.

Two primary predictions (locked for version 1):

1. **Near-threshold heterogeneity** — the elite-pool dip should hit hardest for **borderline** performers (good but not stars), not the very best or the clearly below-average. One exploratory basketball figure exists; not a full tri-domain proof yet.
2. **Peak shift with global capacity (Λ)** — when an organization has more scarce advancement slots (bigger boards, more picks, more tenure lines), the **top** of the inverted-U should move. **Conceptual / prose hook** for now — not a finished cross-domain figure.

One line for Alex: **Draft is unblocked** — empirical triad is the spine; generative is a disciplined supplement, not a gate.

Phase D — Parallel work while drafting (does not block Word)

Workstream	What it is	When it matters
Tenure Cox models (540 Cell 12)	Inferential hazard models beyond the descriptive binned plot — hazard-ratio tables for tenure curvature	Before submission, not before first draft. Cell 9 plot is legitimate for draft prose.
Army figure canon	You name canonical cell, run profile, and filenames after AWS sync (Cursor repo is a digital twin)	Before Alex-facing Army figure is final
Estimand sentences	Three to five approved sentences: Army descriptive binned cumulative-incidence bars (Cell 11) vs inferential Cox models (Cell 12) — not the same object	Alex sign-off before final Army methods wording
Manuscript inking	Paste staging prose into Manuscript_working_outline_v1.docx per ink map	Now

Phase E — Advisor read and submission (TARGET: Summer–Fall 2026)

1. Charles completes first full Word draft (empirical + generative + predictions + limitations).

2. Alex read — revise **claim language** against guardrails, not reopen Path II unless he asks.

3. Close soft gates: tenure Cox table, Army estimand wording, pool-size audit (pre-publication).

4. Submit interdisciplinary science-of-science target (venue TBD).
- Opportunity-cost rule:** If a task does not improve draft quality, claim honesty, or submission readiness → it stays in the parked queue.

Phase F — Parked queue (LATER — mention only if he asks)

Item	Plain English
525 / UIC deep dives	Extra Army work on prestigious units and senior-rater consistency — mechanism meat if the paper needs it
Network extensions	Talent center-of-gravity, talent paradox, exposure networks — dissertation / manuscript §8 future work
Full leave-one-out generative match	Make simulation reproduce empirical poolq_loo curve point-for-point — north-star, parallel to draft
Separate B and D estimation (PD12 P1)	Identify benefit and congestion legs parametrically in all three domains — beyond version 1
Fourth domain (PD12 P4)	Add another empirical setting to stress-test generality

Elevate any parked item only if **Charles or Alex** says so.

4. What to tell him (talk track — expand as needed)

- **Bottleneck shifted:** discovery → **convergence** (model language + manuscript).
- **Paper-first:** empirical triad is the contribution; generative is **minimal POC**, not full LOO replication.
- **Tenure:** third leg is **preliminary** — honest limitations, not equal maturity to Army/MBB.
- **Not blocked on:** generative bin-for-bin LOO match, Fine–Gray, 525/UIC, network §, tenure Cox for *draft*.
- **Phase A done (June):** Tier 1 locks filed; D10 bundle; faculty inference export; staging prose.

5. Parked (mention only if he asks — not seeking decisions today)

Item	One line
525 / UIC	Prestige-org Army depth — revisit if manuscript needs more mechanism meat
Networks	Talent COG, talent paradox — dissertation / later §
LOO generative match	North-star parallel; Path II accepts axis mismatch for v1
Pool-size audit	Pre-publication, not pre-draft

6. If he wants more detail — point, don't recite

Topic	Doc
Full status + dependencies	#03
Plain-English story	#04
Equations / variables	#21
What we can claim	#07
Alex score vs. L_net (say aloud)	Appendix (this doc)
TB-stratify, estimand, Fine–Gray	Talking points doc

7. Meeting notes (Charles — add after)

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Appendix — Alex score vs. **L_net** = B – D (say aloud)

Purpose: Practice language for “two equations, one project — not the same object.”
Canonical nesting: 5-Manuscript/05_Model_Nesting_Note_v1.md · formula decoder 21-Formulas_and_variables.md §1–§2.

A.1 The two equations (say them first)

Your framing (net environment):

$$L_{net} = B(\cdot) - D(\cdot)$$

Alex’s framing (selection score):

$$S_i = A_i - \lambda L_{C,L00,i}$$

Same project. **Not the same object.**

A.2 One sentence each

Equation	Say this
L_net	"How does the local peer environment net out for advancement — upside from strong peers minus downside from crowding them out?"
S_i	"How does the selector rank people — own ability minus a penalty for viable-peer congestion?"

A.3 The significant differences (what to stress aloud)

1. Reduced form vs. selection rule

L_net = B – D		S_i = A_i – λ·L_C
Asks	Why does peer context help <i>and</i> hurt?	Who gets picked when pools are crowded?
Level	Environment → advancement propensity	Individual → ranking score → selection
Role in paper	Conceptual spine + empirical story	Minimal generative proof-of-concept

Say: "Mine is the **why** — benefit and constraint in the environment. Alex's is the **who gets selected** rule that puts congestion into the score."

2. Two legs vs. one leg in the equation

L_net has both:

- B — visibility, norms, minutes, development upside from elite peers
- D — congestion, substitutability, finite slots

Alex's score has **only the D-leg in the formula** (plus own ability):

- Congestion L_C is subtracted from A_i
- B is not a term in S_i — no "minutes bonus" or "development benefit" in the score equation

Say: "Alex's equation is **not B – D**. It's **ability minus congestion** — the constraint leg **entering selection**. The benefit leg lives in my broader frame and in **separate empirical columns** (poolq_loo vs crowding_smooth), not inside his score."

Nesting line: Alex score = **D entering the selection rule**; not the full L_net and not a second model.

3. Own ability: outside vs. inside

- In L_net, own ability A_i is **outside** the decomposition — environment is about **peers**, not you.
- In S_i, own ability is **inside** the score — ranking is explicitly **you vs. congestion**.

Say: "L_net is about the pool around you. S_i is about how evaluators score you given that pool."

4. What you measure empirically vs. what the sim uses

Construct	Empirical world	Alex generative world
Pool "quality"	<code>poolq_loo</code> (LOO teammate quality) — mixes B and D	Often pool mean on roster; LOO quality is a different knob
Congestion	<code>crowding_smooth</code> — D proxy	$L_{C,LOO}$ — viable-peer density, LOO
Outcome curve	Inverted-U on LOO quality	Inverted-U on pool mean when $\lambda > 0$

Say: "Empirically we plot advancement vs **leave-one-out pool quality**. The generative sim shows congestion **in the score** can bend curves on **whole-roster pool mean**. Same story at the mechanism level, **different conditioning object** — and we say that honestly."

5. What each equation is for in v1

- **L_net**: Explains the **inverted-U** (both legs), guides **Rung 2.5** (quality vs. congestion columns), frames **predictions**. **Not separately estimated** as $B(Q)-D(Q)$ in v1.
- **S_i**: Shows **talent-only fails** ($\lambda = 0$) and **congestion-in-score bends curves** — minimal Path II POC. **Not** bin-for-bin replication of empirical `poolq_loo`.

Say: "I'm not claiming we've estimated full **B** and **D** as functions of pool quality. Alex's score isn't claiming to be the whole **L_net** either. It's the **minimal generative piece** that makes congestion matter for **who gets selected**."

A.4 Thirty-second script (practice this)

"We use **one ontology, two readouts**.
L_net = B - D is my reduced form: strong peers can **help** through development and visibility and **hurt** through congestion and substitutability — that's the inverted-U story.
Alex's score is narrower: **ability minus viable-peer congestion** in the **selection rule**. That operationalizes the **constraint leg** — who stands out when everyone around you is also viable — not the full benefit-minus-constraint decomposition.
Empirically we see the curve on **leave-one-out pool quality**; the simulation shows congestion in the score can produce non-monotone curves on a **different axis**, with the limitation stated explicitly. Same model family, different rung."

A.5 What not to say (Alex will push back)

Avoid	Say instead
"Alex's equation is my model."	"Alex's score nects inside my frame as the D-leg in selection."
"We estimated B – D ."	"We decompose conceptually ; v1 has quality vs. congestion columns , not full B(Q)–D(Q) ."
"The sim reproduces <code>poolq_loo</code> ."	"The sim shows congestion in the score matters; empirical U is on LOO quality ."
"S_i includes development benefits."	"B shows up in theory and in proxies like minutes; not in S_i."

A.6 If he asks: "So are they the same or different?"

Short answer:

"Same project, different job.
*L_net is the **environment story** — why elite pools can help on average but hurt at the top.*
*S_i is the **selection story** — how congestion enters **ranking** when slots are scarce.*
*The score is the **minimal generative implementation** of the constraint side, sitting under the broader **B – D** frame — not a competing model."*

Path II in one breath: not two models fighting — **one ladder** (phenomenon → minimal score POC → quality-vs-congestion measurements → predictions).

A.7 Quick reference — S vs L vs L_net (not the same symbol)

Symbol	Level	Plain English	In data / code
S _i	Individual	Ranking score: ability minus congestion penalty	Latent in generative sim (538D CELL 10); not observed in Army/MBB/tenure panels
L _C / λ·L _C	Individual-in-pool	Congestion channel — D leg inside S	crowding_smooth (empirical D proxy)
poolq_loo / L _Q	Individual-in-pool	LOO teammate quality — mixes B and D	Empirical x-axis (Rung 1); often decreasing on sim Plot B when SHOW_PLOT_B_TEAM_MEAN=False
Pool mean / team_mean	Pool	Whole-roster average ability	Generative Plot B x-axis when SHOW_PLOT_B_TEAM_MEAN=True (539-style)
L _{net} = B – D	Theory	Why environment helps and hurts	Conceptual spine — not a column you regress directly in v1

Mnemonic: S = who (rank). L = where (pool context on the plot). L_{net} = why (help minus hurt).

Critical: poolq_loo is not ≈ λ·L_C. Congestion is one ingredient in selection; pool quality is a **mixed** environment readout.

A.8 Bridging the two plots (same Y, different X — how the formulas connect)

Your question: Alex side feels like score → draft; your side is pool quality → draft. How do we link them?

What Alex’s equation is for — simulation vs. explanation (read this twice)

Your insight is correct. Alex’s score is primarily a **simulation rule**, not a claim that this one equation **fully explains** your empirical inverted-U on poolq_loo.

Layer	Object	Job in v1	What we claim
Empirical (Rung 1)	Inverted-U on poolq_loo	The phenomenon — established Army + MBB; preliminary tenure	Pattern is real and replicated (honest tenure caveat)
Theory (spine)	L _{net} = B – D	Why help and hurt can coexist in the same peer environment	Conceptual decomposition — not separately estimated as B(Q)–D(Q) in v1
Generative (Rung 2)	S = A – λ·L _C → top K	Minimal POC engine — run a disciplined simulation	Congestion in the score matters; talent-only fails (λ = 0)

What the sim proves (and does not):

Alex sim does	Alex sim does not
Show that ability-only selection cannot produce the generative story you need	Claim to reproduce your empirical curve on <code>poolq_loo</code> bin-for-bin
Show that adding congestion to the score can bend aggregate selection curves (on pool mean in v1 POC)	Replace <code>L_net</code> as the explanation for why elite pools help on average but hurt at the top
Operationalize the D-leg inside selection — who stands out when peers are viable substitutes	Put the B-leg (development, visibility, minutes) inside the score equation
Earn its place as a Wang-style minimal mechanism supplement	Serve as the only model of the empirical inverted-U

One sentence: Alex’s equation **runs** the generative world; `L_net` **frames** the empirical world. The sim asks: *“Is congestion in selection plausibly necessary?”* — not *“Does this score equal your observed U on LOO quality?”*

Path II honesty (say aloud): “We do **not** claim the simulation **is** the inverted-U. We claim the simulation shows a **minimal ingredient** — congestion in ranking — without which the generative story fails, while the **empirical** inverted-U lives on a **different conditioning axis** (`poolq_loo` vs pool mean), stated explicitly.”

Both plots share one Y:

Y-axis	
Empirical (you)	P(drafted) or mean draft rate in bin
Generative (Alex POC)	P(selected) or mean selection rate in bin

Same object: **advancement probability**.

Different conditioning (X) — and a common confusion

Plot	Typical X-axis	What X means
Your empirical readout	<code>poolq_loo</code> (LOO pool quality)	Observable local environment — B and D still bundled
Alex generative readout (Plot B)	<code>team_mean</code> (pool mean) — Path II default	Pool-level ability after soft assignment; not individual S_i on the axis
Alex (alternate Plot B)	<code>poolq_loo</code> / L _Q	LOO quality axis — closer to yours, but sim often does not reproduce empirical U with same knobs

Important correction: The main generative **figure** is usually **not** “score vs draft probability.” **S_i** works **inside** the sim (rank everyone, take top K). The **published** generative plot is “**selection rate vs pool feature**” — same *kind* of figure as yours (environment on X, outcome on Y), but a **different pool statistic** on X (pool mean vs LOO quality).

At the **individual** level (behind the plot):

Higher **S_i** → higher chance i is in top-K → higher P(**Y_i** = 1)

At the **aggregated** level (what you actually draw):

Bin by pool environment **L** → plot mean P(**Y**) in each bin

The bridge formula (conceptual)

Think in two steps:

Step 1 — Micro (Alex selection rule):

$S_i = A_i - \lambda \cdot L_{C,i} \Rightarrow Y_i = 1 \text{ if } S_i \text{ in top } K \text{ (or top } \Lambda)$

Step 2 — Macro (your empirical stylized fact):

$E[Y \mid L_Q] = \text{mean draft rate in pools with LOO quality } L_Q$

Link:

$E[Y \mid L_Q] \approx E[1\{S \text{ in top } K\} \mid L_Q]$

The **left** is your curve (phenomenon). The **right** is what the sim **aggregates** after running the score rule inside each pool. **L_{net} = B – D** explains **why** the left-hand curve can rise then fall: mid-quality pools net-help; top pools net-hurt once **D** dominates **B**. $\lambda \cdot L_C$ in **S** is only the **congestion channel** in the ranking step — not the full mixed **L** on your x-axis.

Empirical (Rung 1)		Generative (Rung 2)	Theory (spine)
Question	How does draft rate vary with peer pool quality ?	Can congestion in the score bend selection curves?	Why help and hurt?
X	<code>poolq_loo</code>	<code>team_mean</code> (v1 POC axis)	—
Y	P(drafted)	P(selected)	—
Mechanism in prose	$L_{net}(L_Q) = B - D$	$S = A - \lambda \cdot L_C \rightarrow \text{top } K$	B leg + D leg
What we claim	Inverted-U replicated (Army, MBB)	Congestion matters ; talent-only fails	Decomposition + limitations

One paragraph to say aloud (plot bridge)

“Both figures plot **advancement probability on Y**. Mine puts **leave-one-out pool quality** on X — that’s the **empirical inverted-U** we’re trying to explain. Alex’s score doesn’t go on the x-axis. It **runs inside** the simulation: rank everyone with **S**, take top K, then plot **selection rate against pool mean**. So at the micro level **S** governs who wins slots; at the macro level **L** on my x-axis is the pool environment I condition on.

Here’s the key distinction: `L_net = B - D` is my **why** — benefit and constraint in the environment. **Alex’s score** is a **minimal simulation rule** — ability minus congestion in **ranking**. It shows congestion **matters** for selection (talent-only fails). It does **not** claim to be the full explanation of my empirical U on LOO quality, and it doesn’t put the B-leg inside the score. The sim is a **proof-of-concept engine**; the inverted-U on `poolq_loo` is the **phenomenon**; `L_net` is the **conceptual bridge** between them.”

What would make them line up more (deferred — say honestly)

Full alignment would require the sim to reproduce `poolq_loo` bin-for-bin (LOO generative match — **parked**). v1 instead states the **axis mismatch** explicitly: same mechanism family, **different conditioning object** on X.

A.9 Thought experiment — same axis (`poolq_loo`), both show inverted-U

Bracket axis mismatch for a minute. Suppose Army is re-run on LOO pool quality and the inverted-U holds. Suppose the generative sim is also read on `poolq_loo` (or LOO-quality bins) and — with congestion in the score — also bends down at the top. **How do we explain that?**

Step 0 — What you’re looking at (same picture twice)

Both sides plot the **same kind of object**:

X = LOO pool quality (`poolq_loo`)
Y = P(advance) or mean advancement rate in bin
Shape = rise through mid tiers, fall in elite tier

Empirical = **observed** officers / players / faculty. Generative = **simulated** agents after running the score rule. Same axes, same qualitative shape.

Step 1 — What the empirical curve is saying

Plain English: As the quality of your **local peer pool** (excluding yourself) goes up, advancement first goes up, then goes down.

What `poolq_loo` captures: A **mixed** readout of the peer environment — better teammates/colleagues on average, but also denser clusters of strong substitutes. You see the **net** curve; you do not yet see B and D separately on that axis.

`L_net = B - D` reading of the shape:

Region of X	Story (conceptual)
Low → mid pool quality	Net environment helps — visibility, norms, development upside from stronger peers (B dominates net)
Mid → elite pool quality	Net environment hurts at the margin — too many similarly strong, substitutable peers competing for scarce slots (D dominates net)

The inverted-U is the **signature** that both forces exist in the same local comparison pool.

Step 2 — What Alex’s score does inside the aligned sim

Micro rule (unchanged):

$$S_i = A_i - \lambda \cdot L_{C,i}$$

(ability minus viable-peer congestion)

Rank by $S_i \rightarrow$ top K get $Y_i = 1$

Why congestion alone can bend the curve on `poolq_loo`:

- In **higher** LOO-quality pools, more agents are **viable substitutes** (high A, above threshold).
- Congestion **L_C** is high → **S** is compressed for many people — especially **near-threshold** types who are good but not dominant.
- Even with strong own ability, harder to land in top **K** when everyone around you is also viable.
- **Aggregate** selection rate in the top pool-quality bins can **fall** even though the pool is “better.”

Talent-only null ($\lambda = 0$): Score $\approx$ ability only → selection tracks talent → curve tends **monotone** (better pool → more high-A people → no elite-tier dip). **Fails** to match inverted-U. That is the generative falsification.

With $\lambda > 0$: Congestion enters ranking → non-monotone **selection vs pool quality** becomes **plausible on the same X** as the data.

Step 3 — How sim and data connect when axes match

Layer	Question	Answer when aligned
Data	Does advancement bend on LOO pool quality?	Yes — stylized fact (Army, MBB; tenure preliminary)
Sim	Can congestion-in-score produce that bend on the same X ?	Yes — minimal mechanism POC (if knobs reproduce shape)
Theory	Why would both be true in one framework?	L_{net} — same ontology; sim operationalizes D in selection ; environment story explains rise and fall

Bridge (aligned case):

E[Y | poolq_loo] ≈ E[1{S in top K} | poolq_loo] (same X, same Y kind)

Left = empirical inverted-U. Right = what the sim **aggregates** after running **S** inside each pool-quality bin.

Step 4 — What Alex’s equation explains vs what **L_{net}** still adds

Even with perfect axis alignment, the jobs **do not collapse**:

Alex score S		L_{net} = B - D
Explains downturn?	Yes, via D in ranking — congestion at the top	Yes, via net constraint — D dominates B in elite pools
Explains upturn?	Only indirectly — better pools may have more dispersion; not a B term in S	Explicitly — B leg (development, visibility, upside)
What’s on the x-axis?	Same poolq_loo — still bundles B and D	Decomposition concept — not two separate estimated curves in v1
Generative role	Simulation engine — shows D-in-selection is necessary for the shape	Narrative spine — why the bundled x-axis should bend

Crisp sentence: Aligned axes mean sim and data tell the **same qualitative story on the same plot**. Alex’s score explains **how congestion in ranking can generate the downturn**. **L_{net}** explains **why the whole environment curve rises then falls** (help and hurt in one frame) — including the part of the rise that is **not** inside the score equation.

Step 5 — What you would still not claim (even if aligned)

- That you **estimated** separate B(Q) and D(Q) functions
- That **S** includes development benefits (B-leg) — it does not
- **Parametric identity** — same shape ≠ same coefficients / same bins
- **Causation** — associational language throughout

- That one basketball generative preset **proves** Army and tenure

v1 claim (aligned version): Cross-domain **phenomenon** on LOO pool quality + **minimal generative ingredient** (congestion in score necessary; talent-only fails) on the **same conditioning axis** + `L_net` as the conceptual decomposition + honest limitations on tenure and estimation.

Thirty-second script (aligned-axis version)

*"Imagine both plots use leave-one-out pool quality on X and advancement rate on Y, and both show the inverted-U. The data curve says: elite peer pools stop helping at the top. The simulation runs Alex's score inside each pool — ability minus congestion, top K selected — and can reproduce that downturn when congestion is on. Talent-only can't. So the sim shows congestion in **selection** is a **minimal necessary ingredient** for the shape. My `L_net` frame still adds the **why** in two legs: peers can help through development and visibility and hurt through substitutability and finite slots — the score puts only the constraint leg into ranking, not the full benefit-minus-constraint story."*

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Print (dense): `./scripts/convert_multiple_md_to_pdf.sh --narrow 30`